

Alenio App Update & Version Release Process

Use this checklist every time you ship a new mobile build and want users on older builds to see an Update available prompt (with bullets), then What's New after they upgrade.

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What the system does

- Soft update prompt: users below `MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION` see Update available with your bullets, Update now, and Later.
- Force update (optional): users below `MOBILE_MINIMUM_VERSION` must update (no Later). Keep at 0.0.0 until you need it.
- What's New: after they install the new app version, a one-time in-app modal shows bullets from `mobile/src/lib/whats-new.ts`.
- Update now opens `IOS_APP_STORE_URL` or `ANDROID_PLAY_STORE_URL` from Railway.

Files & Railway variables

Mobile (in the repo)

- `mobile/app.json` - `expo.version` (example: 1.0.04) and iOS `buildNumber` / Android `versionCode` as needed
- `mobile/src/lib/whats-new.ts` - `WHATS_NEW_BY_VERSION` bullets for the version you just shipped (post-update modal)

Railway (Alenio Backend - Prod)

- `MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION` - store version users should be on (must match the new `app.json` version)
- `MOBILE_MINIMUM_VERSION` - usually 0.0.0; raise only to force-update broken builds
- `MOBILE_UPDATE_BULLETS` - bullets for the Update available screen (pipe | or newlines). Example: Bug Fixes|Support for Alenio Go|Pin chat messages
- `MOBILE_UPDATE_TITLE` - optional title on the update modal
- `IOS_APP_STORE_URL` - `https://apps.apple.com/app/idYOUR_APP_ID`
- `ANDROID_PLAY_STORE_URL` - `https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.vibecode.alenio9iqp9v`

Full release process (do in order)

Step 1. Bump the app version

- Open `mobile/app.json`
- Change `expo.version` to the new version (e.g. 1.0.03 -> 1.0.04)
- Bump iOS `buildNumber` and Android `versionCode` if your store process requires it

Step 2. Write What's New bullets (after update)

- Open `mobile/src/lib/whats-new.ts`
- Add an entry keyed to the SAME version string as `app.json`
- Use 2-5 short user-facing bullets

```
"1.0.04": {  
  title: "What's new in Alenio",  
  bullets: [  
    "Short benefit one",  
    "Short benefit two",
```

```
"Short benefit three",
],
},
```

Step 3. Build & submit to the stores

- Create the iOS / Android store builds (EAS or your usual pipeline)
- Submit and wait until the new version is available on the App Store / Play Store
- Do NOT set MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION on Railway until the store listing is live

Step 4. Set Railway update prompt (for users still on old builds)

- In Railway -> Alenio Backend Prod -> Variables, set the values below
- No trailing spaces in variable NAMES
- Redeploy / restart the backend after changing variables so they take effect

```
MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION=1.0.04
MOBILE_MINIMUM_VERSION=0.0.0
MOBILE_UPDATE_TITLE=What's new in this update
MOBILE_UPDATE_BULLETS=Bullet one|Bullet two|Bullet three
IOS_APP_STORE_URL=https://apps.apple.com/app/idYOUR_APP_ID
ANDROID_PLAY_STORE_URL=https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.vibecode.alenio9iqp9v
```

Step 5. Verify the API

- Open: <https://alenio-backend-production.up.railway.app/api/app-version>
- Confirm latestVersion, bullets, and store URLs look correct

```
{"data":{"latestVersion":"1.0.04","minimumVersion":"0.0.0","bullets":["..."],"iosStoreUrl":"...","androidStoreUrl":"..."}}
```

Step 6. What users experience

- Old build: soft Update available modal with your Railway bullets; Update now opens the store; Later dismisses until the next latestVersion change
- After they install the new build: What's New modal once, using bullets from whats-new.ts for that version
- First install of a version never shows What's New for that same install (silent mark-as-seen)

Force update (only when needed)

If a bad build must be blocked, set MOBILE_MINIMUM_VERSION to the lowest version still allowed (e.g. 1.0.04). Anyone below that sees Update required with no Later button. Use carefully - this blocks the app.

Testing checklist (dev)

- Temporarily set MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION higher than your installed app (e.g. 9.9.11) and set MOBILE_UPDATE_BULLETS
- Redeploy backend; confirm /api/app-version
- Reload the signed-in app - soft prompt should appear
- Update now should open the store (or App Store search if iOS URL is missing)
- Later dismisses; bump latestVersion again to re-show
- Reset test vars when done (set MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION back to the real live store version)

Quick reference - who writes what

- Update available bullets (old installs): YOU on Railway (MOBILE_UPDATE_BULLETS) - required so old apps can fetch them
- What's New bullets (after upgrade): YOU in mobile/src/lib/whats-new.ts - ships inside the new app build
- Keep both in sync with the same themes when you can, but Railway is the source for the pre-update screen

Common mistakes

- Setting MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION before the store build is live - users tap Update now and cannot get the new version yet
- Forgetting to redeploy Railway after changing env vars - /api/app-version still shows old/null values
- Typos or trailing spaces in variable names (e.g. MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION)
- Editing only whats-new.ts and expecting the Update available modal to change for people still on old builds - it will not; use Railway bullets
- Mismatch between app.json version and MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION / whats-new.ts key